OFFICIAL RULEBOOK

GANDHI HACKATHON

Acha hua yeh din dekhne se pehle mar gaya

Organised by OpenLake · The Open Source Society of IIT Bhilai

A MERAZ EVENT · TECHNO-CULTURAL FEST OF IIT BHILAI



5 HOURS · TEAMS OF 3 · SOLO REGISTRATION

01 ABOUT THE HACKATHON

The Gandhi Hackathon is a five-hour build sprint hosted by OpenLake, the open source society of IIT Bhilai, as part of Meraz, the institute's techno-cultural fest.

The premise is simple. You arrive without knowing what you will build. You are placed in a team you did not choose. Five hours later you present something that works, and then you tell the judges what you think it is worth.

There is no pre-built work, no prepared repository and no advantage to planning ahead, because nobody — participant or organiser — knows what the problem statement will ask for until the clock starts.

Format at a glance

Item	Detail
Duration	5 hours of build time
Team size	3 members, assigned randomly by the organisers
Registration	Solo — you register as an individual, not as a team
Problem statement	Released immediately before the hackathon begins
Tracking	All work tracked via GitHub commit history
Submission	GitHub repository + live working URL
Judging	Presentation round in the Latent format
Date	[To be announced]
Reporting time	[To be announced]
Venue	[To be announced]

02 REGISTRATION AND TEAM FORMATION

Registration is solo. You sign up as an individual. You do not need a team, you cannot bring a team, and you cannot request specific teammates.

Teams are assigned at random. Once registration closes, the organisers will randomly allocate every registered participant into a team of three. Team allocations are announced before the hackathon begins and are final.

Rules on teams

- Team allocations are final. Swap requests, trades and "we already know each other" appeals will not be entertained.
- Every member of a team shares the same final score. There are no individual placements within a team.

03 THE OBJECTIVE

There is exactly one objective:

> **Build whatever the problem statement asks you to build, and have it working by the end of the five hours.**

The problem statement is released immediately before the hackathon starts. It is the same statement for every team. It will not be shared, hinted at or previewed in advance to anyone, including volunteers.

What this means in practice

- You may use any language, framework, library or hosting provider you like, unless the problem statement restricts it.
- Scope realistically. Five hours is short. A small thing that works beats a large thing that does not.

04 WORK TRACKING ON GITHUB

All work must be done on GitHub, and your GitHub history is what the judges will treat as the record of what your team actually did.

Requirements

1. Create a public GitHub repository at the start of the hackathon, after the problem statement is released.
2. All three members must commit from their own GitHub accounts. A repository with commits from only one account will be questioned.
3. Commit regularly throughout the five hours. A single commit at the end gives the judges nothing to evaluate and will be treated as suspicious.

> **COMMIT HISTORY IS EVIDENCE**
>
> The judges will read your commit timeline. Steady, attributable commits across all three members tell a story that supports your presentation. A repository that appears fully formed in the final ten minutes tells a different one.

05 SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

A submission is complete only when both of the following are provided before the deadline:

Required	Specification
GitHub repository	Public URL, with full commit history intact and commits from all team members
Live working URL	A deployed, publicly reachable link that a judge can open in a browser and use

What counts as a live URL

- Anything a judge can open from their own device without installing software or being granted access.
- Free hosting is entirely acceptable — Vercel, Netlify, Render, GitHub Pages or equivalent.

Submissions that will not be accepted

- Any work that existed before the problem statement was released.

- A submission arriving after the deadline, for any reason other than one the organisers caused.

06 PRESENTATION AND JUDGING

After the five hours end, every team presents. The presentation round runs in the format of the comedy show Latent by Samay Raina, adapted for a hackathon.

How the round works

1. Your team presents your work to the judges and the room — what the problem statement asked, what you built, and a live demonstration using your deployed URL.
2. At the end of your presentation, your team states the score you think you deserve.
3. The judges then reveal the score they actually gave you.
4. How close your guess was to the judges' score counts towards your final result.

So there are two things to get right. Building something good, and knowing honestly how good it is. Overselling weak work costs you. So does underselling strong work.

> **JUDGE YOURSELF HONESTLY**
>
> The self-scoring component rewards accurate self-assessment, not modesty and not bravado. A team that builds something average and correctly calls it average scores better on this component than a team that builds something average and calls it exceptional.

Scoring components

Component	Weight	What is assessed
Quality of the build	[TBC]	How well the problem statement was solved, whether it works, and the craft behind it
Self-score accuracy	[TBC]	How close your stated score was to the judges' score

Exact weightings and the presentation time limit per team will be confirmed by the organisers before the event begins.

What the judges look for in the build

- Does it do what the problem statement asked, and does it actually work when opened?
- Was the scope sensible for five hours?
- Does the commit history show genuine work from all three members?

07 CODE OF CONDUCT

This is a student event at IIT Bhilai, run under Meraz. The standard of behaviour expected is the standard expected anywhere on campus.

Expected of every participant

- Treat your randomly assigned teammates, other teams, volunteers and judges with basic respect.
- Accept the judges' decisions. Disagree in words, to a POC, after the round.

Prohibited

- Submitting work that was not built during the hackathon.
- Falsifying commit history, authorship or timestamps.
- Plagiarising another team's work, or sharing your work with another team.
- Any other dishonest or morally wrong practice, whether or not it is listed above.

08 PENALTIES AND AUTHORITY

The judges and POCs hold **full and final authority** to penalise or ban any team or individual found using false methods or engaging in morally wrong practices, including fighting and violence.

The scale of response

Action	When it applies
Warning	A first, minor or ambiguous breach
Score penalty	Breaches affecting the fairness of the result
Disqualification	Falsified work, plagiarism or serious misrepresentation
Removal and ban	Fighting, violence, harassment, or repeated breaches

- A penalty may apply to an individual or to their whole team, at the organisers' discretion. The list of prohibited conduct above is not exhaustive — conduct that is clearly dishonest or clearly wrong is penalisable whether or not this document names it.
- Decisions made by the judges and POCs are final and are not subject to appeal.

09 COMMUNICATION

All official communication happens through the official WhatsApp channel. Problem statement release, team allocations, schedule changes, deadline reminders, submission instructions and results are announced there and nowhere else.

- Joining the official WhatsApp channel is mandatory for every registered participant.
- Direct any query to a POC listed below rather than to the channel at large.

Points of contact

Coordinator	Contact
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"My life is my message."

— Mohandas Gandhi